



Dancing with the wii

### **What about their social skills, their health?**

Isn't being in a zombie-like state putting a dampener on their social skills? Not if adults involve themselves in the child's gaming activity. It is a commonly accepted fact that team activities help develop social skills and self-esteem. It's the same with gadgets. Kids get a boost in confidence when they're able to show off their knowledge of how gadget controls work and act as teachers to adults showing them, for example, how to get around certain obstacles like skipping an ad to get to a video quicker.

Children now have the never before seen ability to connect with other kids from all over the globe, giving them access to other cultures through cartoons like Peppa Pig and Dora the Explorer. Their minds are expanded thanks to different points of view and ways of seeing the world even before they're 10.

Parents encouraging kids to use interactive media together with them soon learn of the many opportunities their toddler comes across to move their bodies, dance and exercise. Barely 6 years of age, Caytlin Fernandes can go to YouTube, look for choreography videos for her favourite songs and imitate the steps within a few minutes. Exergaming, i.e. games that require players to perform physical activities in order to play a game (Dance